Toni M. Nicolas (she/her)

Product Designer (UX/UI) · CMS & Digital Product Design

contact@tmndesigns.com · linkedin.com/in/toninicolas · Mount Vernon, WA

SUMMARY

Product Designer who owns the full cycle — design, build, and delivery — end to end, typically as the only design/product resource on the team. Career began in 2018 building digital products and visual systems for clients; since 2021, has led UX strategy, front-end execution, and platform delivery across education, SaaS, and agency environments without a dedicated handoff between disciplines. Known for taking ambiguous, high-stakes problems (CMS migrations, 0→1 builds, governance overhauls) from discovery through launch solo, combining UX judgment, hands-on front-end work, and cross-functional stakeholder management in a single role.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Product Designer (Web & UI/UX Specialist 2)

Skagit Valley College · Dec 2023 – Present · Mount Vernon, WA · Hybrid

- Own product strategy, roadmap planning, and UX execution across the full platform lifecycle, partnering with Marketing, IT, academic departments, senior leadership, and external vendors.
- Led end-to-end delivery of a 600+ page CMS migration (WordPress → Omni CMS), resolving governance failures, accessibility risk, and content sprawl through a phased roadmap designed and owned from scratch.
- Standardized 120+ academic program pages into a student-centered design system — reducing bounce rates by up to 79% and increasing Apply Now interactions by 22%.
- Proposed and delivered a centralized policies library from scratch, resolving critical compliance gaps and establishing sustainable governance workflows that didn't previously exist.

UX Designer

RTOWN · Jul 2021 – Jan 2023 · Vancouver, BC · Remote

- Led product design and user research from discovery through launch for client-facing digital products across e-commerce, portals, and internal tools.
- Designed a guest portal for a long-term stay platform, contributing to a 20% increase in booking retention.
- Directed a headless e-commerce UX rebuild enabling scalable architecture and streamlined inventory management across four brands, contributing to a 20% increase in agency MRR.

UX Designer · Web Application

SWITCH Song Library App (Contract) · Jul – Aug 2023 · Vancouver, BC

- Pitched and validated a 0→1 web app serving ~70,000 users/month to replace a 2,000-page PDF song library — owned problem framing, wireframing, UX/UI design, and dev coordination under a tight timeline
- Led rapid in-context testing during a live weekend launch, shipping on-the-spot fixes based on direct user behavior

Web Developer · CMS Migration Specialist (Contract)

SBCTC · Oct 2024 – Jan 2025 · Remote

- Supported UX and content execution for a large-scale CMS migration to Modern Campus templates for a statewide higher education system
- Conducted content audits, sitemap analysis, and accessibility-focused cleanup to improve navigation quality and platform consistency

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Product (UX/UI) Designer, DMB Solutions (2023) — Led end-to-end delivery of company website and client portal; selected and configured CRM to support online and local sales operations; contributed to sales growth from ~$30K to $150K annually.
- Lead Tech Instructor, Black Girls Code, New York (Aug 2024, Aug 2026) — Designed and facilitated AI-driven curriculum and game design workshops for 25–50 students aged 11–18, blending generative AI literacy with hands-on creative development over a 2-week summer coding camp.
- Web Designer, Moonman Studios (2020–21) — Designed and developed branded e-commerce and business websites, including splitting a parent brand into four distinct entities through individual site design; contributed to 15% sales increase and 25% traffic growth across client accounts.
- Learning Experience Designer, Cosmo Global, Japan (2020) — Designed interactive curriculum and cross-cultural instruction for middle school students across three schools Graphic Design Tutor, Rasmussen (2019–21) — 1:1 instruction, problem diagnosis, and independent learning facilitation.
- WordPress Developer & Web Designer, Freelance (2018–21) — Designed and built WordPress websites and visual identities end-to-end across multiple client engagements and industries.

EDUCATION

Rasmussen University BS, Graphic Design · AS, Web & Interactive Design
British Columbia Institute of Technology Certificate, Technical Web Design

SKILLS

Design & Strategy: Product design, UX systems, interaction design, wireframing, prototyping, usability testing, information architecture, design systems, accessibility (WCAG), analytics-informed design

Platform & Delivery: CMS strategy & governance, content architecture, roadmap planning, cross-functional delivery, stakeholder management, requirements definition, product discovery

Tools: Figma, Miro, Notion, GA4, Smartsheet, Adobe CC (XD, Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign), HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, PHP, MySQL, Python